

Hydrothermal vent An opening on the seafloor that pours out hot water and chemicals from inside Earth's crust.

Hyphae The root-like structures produced by fungi and molds.

Invertebrate An animal without a backbone.

Larvae The intermediate stage that insects pass through, often as a grub or caterpillar, before they become an adult.

Mammal An animal that has fur or hair and feeds its young on milk.

Marsupial A mammal that gives birth to underdeveloped young, which it carries in a pouch.

Meiosis A method of reproduction whereby offspring have a different combination of genes from their parents.

Messenger RNA A single-stranded nucleic acid used to copy and make proteins in a cell.

Mitochondria The parts of a cell that convert food into energy.

Mitosis A method of reproduction that produces offspring that are identical to the parent.

Migrate To move from one area to another to breed or feed, usually at a set time each year.

Molecule A group of at least two atoms held together by a chemical bond.

Mutualism A relationship between two organisms from which both species benefit.

Nutrient A substance that is essential for the growth and maintenance of an organism.

Omnivore An animal that eats meat, plants, and fungi.

Organism A living thing.

Parasite An organism that uses another organism to help it survive, but causes harm to its host.

Parthenogenesis The method used by some animals to reproduce without the need for a mate. It results in female offspring that are identical to the mother.

Photosynthesis The process plants use to make sugars out of water, carbon dioxide, and light.

Pigment A chemical compound that gives something its color.

Pollination The process by which flowering plants transfer pollen so they can reproduce and set seed.

Population The number of any one species living in a particular place.

Predator An animal that kills and eats other animals.

Prey An animal that is hunted and killed by another for food.

Protists Microorganisms with very simple cell structures.

Reptile A cold-blooded animal with a scaly skin. Most lay eggs but some give birth to live young.

Scavenger An animal that feeds on animals that have died or been killed, or on dead plants and fungi.

Species A group of living things that share similar characteristics, such as shape, size, and coloring.



Spore A reproductive structure used by organisms because it can survive difficult conditions. Many bacteria, fungi, algae, and plants use spores.

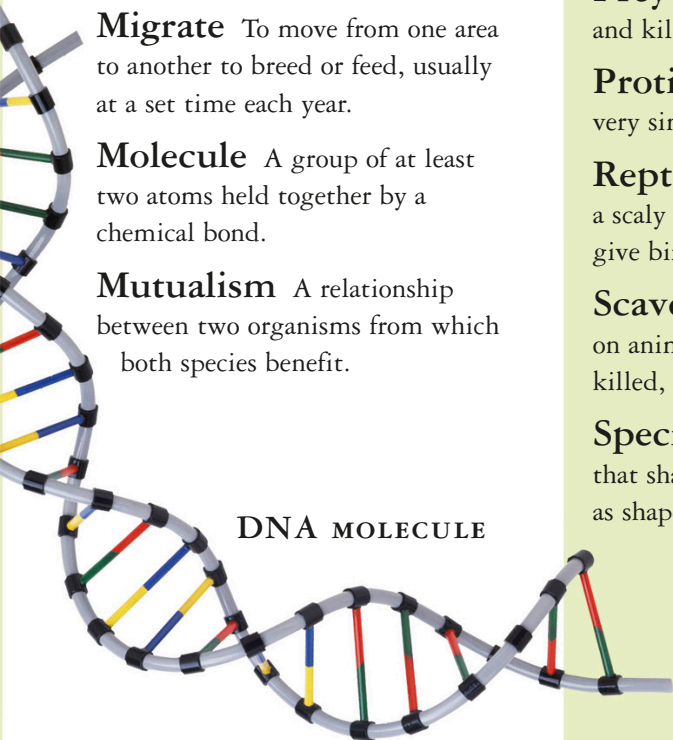
Stomata (*Singular* stoma) Tiny openings in the outer layer of a leaf that allow gases in and out.

Thorax The area of an animal's body that lies between the head and the abdomen.

Vascular system A system of cells that carry water and nutrients around a plant.

Vertebrate An animal that has a backbone.

SCAVENGER



DNA MOLECULE